

MediLink

Pharmacist&Pharmacy Research Analysis

Week 1 UX Research • Two Pharmacist Interviews

Research objective: Understand pharmacy workflows, recurring operational problems, medicine availability challenges, prescription-related issues, stock management, and the needs that a digital platform could potentially address.

1. Research Participants&Method

Participant	Profile	Method	Main Focus
Pharmacist 1	Pharmacist + Pharmacy Owner/Manager	Semi-structured interview	Prescription workflow, pharmacist– doctor communication, medicine availability, orders/stock, patient-related needs
Pharmacist 2	Pharmacist / Pharmacy	Semi-structured interview	OTC and chronic-medication workflow, orders, stock, availability, alternatives, digital systems

Note: The first interview was recorded through handwritten notes. Findings below summarize the themes visible in the interview notes; they should be treated as qualitative evidence from one participant, not as a general rule for all pharmacies.

2. Interview 1– Key Findings

- Prescription handling and review are important parts of the pharmacist workflow, with potential issues that may require clarification.
- Communication with doctors can be needed when there is an issue or uncertainty related to a prescription.
- Medicine availability is an operational concern, especially when a prescribed medicine is not readily available.
- The pharmacy workflow includes managing medicine orders and stock, creating opportunities for better organization and visibility.
- Pharmacists need accurate medicine information to support safe dispensing and patient communication.

3. Interview 2– Key Findings

- The pharmacy handles a large amount of OTC medication, repeat purchases for chronic conditions such as hypertension and diabetes, and patient consultations.
- Orders currently arrive mainly through WhatsApp and prescriptions.
- There is currently no dedicated system for tracking an order from receipt until delivery; patients often collect the medicine themselves.
- Order errors can occur when an item is forgotten or the wrong item is supplied. The current solution is manual communication with the supplier.
- Medicine availability is a major challenge. When a medicine is unavailable, the pharmacy searches nearby pharmacies or other pharmacies it works with.
- The pharmacist specifically mentioned Eltroxin as an example of a medicine that can be difficult to source.
- Stock decisions are based on current stock balance and average consumption, using pharmacy sales and purchase/inventory data.
- For a platform combining prescriptions, orders, and stock, the pharmacist considered the scientific name/active ingredient and available alternatives important.

4. Pain Points Identified

Pain Point	Evidence/ Interpretation	Evidence Level
Medicine availability	Both interviews point to difficulty obtaining medicines when they are unavailable.	Repeated
Prescription-related clarification	The first interview indicates a need to deal with prescription issues and communicate with doctors when clarification is needed.	Interview 1
Manual order handling	Interview 2 describes WhatsApp/prescription-based ordering and no dedicated order-status tracking.	Interview 2
Order mistakes	Items may be forgotten or an incorrect item may arrive, requiring supplier communication.	Interview 2
Difficulty finding unavailable medicines	The pharmacy may search nearby or partner pharmacies; market shortages make this harder.	Interview 2
Stock / refill monitoring	Stock decisions depend on current balance and average consumption.	Interview 2

Need for medication information and alternatives	Scientific name/active ingredient and available alternatives were explicitly requested.	Interview 2
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5. User Needs

- A clearer way to manage and track pharmacy orders.
- Faster access to medicine availability information.
- Reliable medicine information, including scientific name / active ingredient.
- Visibility of possible available alternatives when appropriate.
- Better support for monitoring stock and identifying refill needs.
- A more organized way to handle prescription-related issues and communication.
- Reduced dependence on scattered manual communication through WhatsApp, phone calls, or supplier messages.

6. Common Findings Across the Two Interviews

Theme	What We Heard	Design Implication
Medicine availability	Both pharmacists described availability as a real operational problem.	Explore a reliable medicine-availability discovery flow.
Workflow organization	Both interviews reveal multiple operational steps that can benefit from clearer organization.	Consider a centralized workflow rather than disconnected communication.
Medication information	Pharmacists need accurate information to identify medicines and handle alternatives.	Make medicine identity and relevant information easy to access.
Digital opportunity	Both interviews suggest areas where manual processes could be organized digitally.	Focus on solving concrete workflow problems rather than adding technology for its own sake.

Important: Not every issue was repeated. Doctor communication was evident in Interview 1, while detailed order tracking, scientific-name/alternative requirements, and stock-refill logic were especially clear in Interview 2.

7. Key Insights

- 01. Medicine availability is not only a patient problem; it also creates work for the pharmacy.** When a medicine is unavailable, the pharmacy may need to search other pharmacies or suppliers.
- 02. Manual communication is still part of the pharmacy workflow.** WhatsApp, prescriptions, and direct communication are being used for orders and problem resolution.

- 03. Pharmacists need medication information that supports practical dispensing decisions.** Scientific name / active ingredient and available alternatives were explicitly mentioned.
- 04. Stock management depends on usage patterns.** Current stock and average consumption are used to decide when a refill is needed.
- 05. The platform should connect workflows, not simply digitize one isolated task.** The interviews point to relationships between prescriptions, availability, orders, stock, and communication.

8. Opportunities for MediLink

Observed Problem	Opportunity
Medicine is unavailable	Medicine availability search across participating / nearby pharmacies.
Order status is unclear	Simple order-status tracking from received → prepared → ready / collected.
Order items can be forgotten or incorrect	Digital order review and confirmation before completion.
Scientific name / alternatives are needed	Medicine details page showing active ingredient and relevant available alternatives.
Stock and consumption are used to decide refill	Stock dashboard with low-stock / refill indicators based on inventory data.
Prescription issues may require clarification	Structured prescription issue / clarification channel between pharmacist and doctor.

9. Possible Feature Opportunities (Not Final MVP)

- Prescription management
- Medicine availability lookup
- Pharmacy-to-pharmacy availability visibility
- Order tracking
- Stock monitoring
- Low-stock / refill alerts
- Medicine details: brand name + scientific name / active ingredient
- Available alternatives information
- Structured pharmacist– doctor communication for prescription clarification

These are opportunity areas, not final product requirements. The final MVP should be selected only after combining pharmacist, doctor, patient, survey, and competitive-analysis evidence.

10. Interview Questions With No Response

In Interview 2, the participant did not answer the following questions, so no conclusions should be drawn from them:

- What benefit would make the pharmacy subscribe to such a platform?
- Preferred payment model: monthly subscription, order commission, or another model?
- The biggest pharmacy-management problem they would like to solve digitally.

11. Research Limitations & Next Steps

- Two pharmacist interviews provide useful qualitative direction, but they are not enough to generalize to all pharmacies.
- Compare these findings with the pharmacist survey responses to identify repeated patterns.
- Compare pharmacist findings with doctor and patient research before finalizing the problem statement and MVP.
- Use competitive analysis to check whether proposed opportunities are already solved by existing products.
- Keep the original interview notes/screenshots as raw research evidence.

12. Preliminary Research Takeaway

Preliminary takeaway: The pharmacist interviews suggest that medicine availability, pharmacy workflow organization, prescription-related coordination, and medication information are meaningful areas to investigate further. A potential MediLink opportunity is to connect these activities into a more organized medication workflow. This conclusion remains preliminary until supported by doctor, patient, survey, and competitive research.